**Sources Sought Notice:**

**CMS QSOG QSED Integrated Surveyor Training Program (ISTP) Contract**
**Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services**
**Quality, Safety & Oversight Group (QSOG)**
**Quality, Safety & Education Division (QSED)**

This is an 8(a) SMALL BUSINESS SOURCES SOUGHT notice. This is NOT a solicitation for proposals, proposal abstracts, or quotations. This sources sought notice does not commit the Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services (CMS) to award a contract in the future.

The purpose of this notice is to obtain information regarding the availability and capability of qualified current 8(a) program participants who have the capacity to provide contract support for the Quality, Safety & Education Portal (QSEP). See 'Background' for additional information. The contract will be procured under the following NAICS: 611430 - Professional and Management Development Training.

The Government does not intend to award a contract on the basis of this notice or otherwise pay for any information solicited. Responses to the information requested will assist the Government in determining the appropriate acquisition method, including whether a set-aside is possible. **An organization that is not considered a current 8(a) program participant should not submit a response to this notice as it will not be reviewed.**

## BACKGROUND

The Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services (CMS) is responsible for administering the mission-critical Medicare/Medicaid surveyor and certification training program and other programs as directed by the Secretary, under contracts with States as provided in Section 1864 of the Social Security Act. CMS is responsible for training State and Federal staff in regard to various Survey & Certification issues.

The CMS CCSQ QSOG, and QSED are responsible for providing leadership, overall programmatic direction and training to Regional Offices (ROs) and State Survey Agencies (SAs) for implementation and enforcement of health quality and safety requirements for Medicare/Medicaid providers and suppliers of health care services. The QSOG/QSED provides nationwide training to State and Federal agencies that carry out Survey and Certification work. The legislation that mandates surveyor training is as follows:

Section 1819(g) of the Social Security Act mandates that the "Secretary of HHS, through the CMS Administrator, assure that surveyors are trained to make determinations about the Conditions of Participation (CoP) of providers." Related authority: US Code, Section 1396 – 1396v, Subchapter XIX, Chapter 7 and Title 42. Also: Chapter IV, Title 42, and Title 45, Code of Federal Regulations. And, Section 1919(g), "Survey and Certification Process," subparagraph (iii), "The Secretary shall provide for the comprehensive training of State and Federal Surveyors in the conduct of standard and extended surveys…." No individual shall serve as a member of a survey team unless the individual has successfully completed a training and testing program in survey and certification techniques that has been approved by the Secretary."

QSOG is responsible for the management of the survey and certification process of all health facilities that provide care to Medicare or Medicaid beneficiaries. This process begins with a survey. There are approximately 8,700 Federal and State surveyors across the nation. Surveyors conduct on-site inspections or surveys, at health facilities, to evaluate and report the extent to which facilities are in compliance with Medicare and Medicaid requirements, to assure basic levels of quality and safety for beneficiaries.

Surveyors inspect various healthcare provider types and are grouped by occupational designations. These occupational groupings include: Long Term Care (LTC), Home Health Agency (HHA), Life Safety Code (LSC), End Stage Renal Disease (ESRD), Hospice, Hospital, Skilled Nursing Facility (SNF), and Intermediate Care Facilities for Individuals with Intellectual Disabilities (ICF/IID) along with several smaller provider types for which training is offered. Recent initiatives toward more effective quality improvement have resulted in QSOG/QSED making surveyor training also available to Healthcare Service Providers. Below are the guidances that various surveyor occupations are trained on:

- Medicare Conditions of Participation (CoPs)
- Skilled Nursing Facilities (SNFs) and Nursing Facilities (NFs)
- Conditions for Coverage (CfCs) are sets of requirements for acceptable quality in the operation of health care entities.

According to the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention (CDC), there were about 350,000 service providers in the U.S. in 2018. This provides an estimation of the number of individuals from the provider community who may require access to the QSEP. The average number of training completions per month is between 3,000 to 6,000.

CMS has primarily been charged with tracking the federal training provided to health care surveyors. The online and web-based courses are currently housed and made available through the integrated learning management system, housed at https://qsep.cms.gov/welcome.aspx. Due to the costs associated with on-site training, the increasing demand for immediate training upon new surveyor hires, increasing number of facilities approved for Medicare/Medicaid participation, and ongoing changes to laws, regulations, policies and procedures, CMS is continuously seeking alternative methods of providing quality training. The QSEP provides access to live and archived online training 24 hours a day, 7 days a week via the internet. Additionally, on-demand training is also available 24 hours a day, 7 days a week. QSEP maintains transcripts of all surveyors.

## CAPABILITY STATEMENT INFORMATION

Please prepare a capability statement addressing your company's knowledge, expertise and experience, within the last three (3) years, for the following requirements listed below. The vendor shall provide enough information for CMS to make a determination as to the capability to perform the same or similar size and scope of work.

Capability statements shall be limited to 5 pages and fonts no smaller than 12 points.

Demonstrate your expertise and experience in the following area(s):

**Quality, Safety & Education Portal**
Describe your experience and ability to:

- Develop, update and maintain accurate, engaging online courses for Surveyors and Healthcare Providers based on the CMS guidance.
- Provide comprehensive administrative support, including reporting, oversight of meetings and development workgroups, technology methodology, and report at a detailed level the usage of the CMS training portal.
- Host and maintain ongoing support for all aspects of the CMS training portal including: security, CMS hosting requirements, new training products and services, Learning Management System (LMS), and help desk (from 7am to 7pm EST) while adapting to new technologies and conditions.
- Maintain a comprehensive tracking and complete living inventory/archive of all learner records/completions, online course materials, trainings, workshops, focus groups, and webinars, graphics, copyright permissions and agreements, model releases, Actors Guild agreements, audio/video recordings of courses, media, digital objects, Training Plans, source files, etc.

References
Include the following information for each reference utilized to demonstrate experiences and capabilities:

- Name of Contracting Activity
- Contract Number, If Applicable
- Period of Performance
- Total Contract Value
- Contracting Officer, Telephone Number and Email Address, as applicable
- Contract Program Manager, Telephone Number and Email Address, as applicable

Note: Please include non-governmental contracts that are applicable.

**ADDITIONAL INFORMATION REQUESTED:**

Interested parties having the capabilities necessary to perform this requirement may submit capability statements in PDF format via email to Danie Ridgway (danie.ridgway@cms.hhs.gov).

CAPABILITY STATEMENTS MUST DEMONSTRATE THE MINIMUM REQUIREMENTS OUTLINED ABOVE. Please address each in order listed above under "Capability Statement Information."

Capability statements shall also include the following in a cover page:

Business Information --
a. DUNS

b. Tax ID
c. Company Name
d. Company Address
e. 8(a) Status must be validated via the System for Award Management (SAM) for the applicable NAICS Codes: 611430 - Professional and Management Development Training. All vendors must be registered in the SAM located at http://www.sam.gov.
f. A statement indicating if you have a government approved accounting system.

Responses must be submitted by **2:00 p.m. ET on December 8, 2020.** Capability statements will not be returned and will not be accepted after the due date.

This notice does not obligate the Government to award a contract or otherwise pay for the information provided in response. The Government reserves the right to use information provided by respondents for any purpose deemed necessary and legally appropriate. Any organization responding to this notice should ensure that its response is complete and sufficiently detailed to allow the Government to determine the organization's qualifications to perform the work. Respondents are advised that the Government is under no obligation to acknowledge receipt of the information received or provide feedback to respondents with respect to any information submitted.

**Confidentiality.** No proprietary, classified, confidential, or sensitive information should be included in your response. The Government reserves the right to use any non-proprietary technical information in any resultant solicitation(s).

**Conflicts of Interest.** It is essential that the vendor be free of all appearance of or actual conflicts of interest. Specifically, the vendor must not have any relationships or arrangements through its business operations or its employees that could be considered as possibly lessening the company's objectivity concerning any aspect of the campaign. If such relationships or arrangements exist, vendors shall be required, during the procurement process, to identify potential conflicts of interest and discuss how the conflicts will be addressed and mitigated.

Questions concerning submission requirements **only** may be directed to Danie Ridgway, Contract Specialist, via email at danie.ridgway@cms.hhs.gov. **CMS will not entertain questions related to contracting strategy.**

**On behalf of the Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services, thank you for your interest in this project.**